FORGE for Success

Participant pages

The take-home page for every FORGE for Success class, and the forms the classes use: the Reentry Plan and the thinking report. Photocopy from this book, one side per sheet; keep this copy clean.

SESSION	HANDOUT	COPIES	PAGE
Orientation	**The Reentry Plan**	1 per resident (kept in the resident's folder)	2
Every class	**Thinking Report**	2 per resident per class, plus extras	3
Orientation	**My First Week**	1 per new resident (kept in the folder; copy the signed page for the resident's record)	4
Class 1	**Thinking Under Pressure**	1 per resident	5
Class 2	**The Officer and Other Authority**	1 per resident	6
Class 3	**Getting Hired: Your Story in Two Minutes**	1 per resident	7
Class 4	**Keeping the Job**	1 per resident	8
Class 5	**Money on the Outside**	2 per resident (one to work on in class, one for home)	9
Class 6	**Coming Home to Family**	1 per resident	10
Class 7	**Old Friends, Old Places**	1 per resident	11
Class 8	**On Guard**	1 per resident (fill in the contacts before copying)	12
Class 9	**Recovery and the Stages of Change**	1 per resident	13
Class 10	**When It Goes Wrong**	1 per resident	14
Class 11	**Giving Back**	1 per resident	15
Class 12	**Your Next Address**	1 per resident	16

FORGE

The Reentry Plan

FORGE FOR SUCCESS · ORIENTATION AND EVERY CLASS

Your plan for life after release. Write specific actions, not wishes: “Apply for a state ID at the DDS office this week,” not “Get my papers together.” Review it with your mentor every week, and add the one action you commit to at the end of every class.

Area	Where I am now	My next step	By when	Done
Housing				
Identification				
Work				
Money				
Health and recovery				
Family				
Supervision and legal				
Service				

Name _____ **Move-in date** _____ **Mentor** _____

Thinking Report

FORGE FOR SUCCESS · THINK, FEEL, ACT

Pick a real situation since you came home where you had a strong reaction. Write what actually went through your mind, not what you think you should have thought. Honesty, not perfection.

Situation	Thought	Feeling	Action	Consequence

A different thought (one that would protect your plan), and where it would have led:

Different thought	Feeling	Action	Consequence

STOP

Stop: don't say or do anything yet; take one breath. **T**hink: what's the thought in my head, and is it a fact? **O**ptions: what are two or three things I could do? **P**lan: pick the one that protects my plan, and do that.

My First Week

FORGE FOR SUCCESS · ORIENTATION · WITH YOUR MENTOR, AT MOVE-IN

My papers (fill this in with your mentor; keep it in your folder)

Document	Have it?	Where it is now, or my next step	By when
State ID			
Social Security card			
Birth certificate			

My first supervision check-in (if I'm on parole or probation)

Date and time _____ **Place** _____ **Officer** _____

Officer's phone _____ **What to bring** _____

My first week (starting the day I moved in)

Day	What	Where	Time
Day 1			
Day 2			
Day 3			
Day 4			
Day 5			
Day 6			
Day 7			

☐ I read the house agreement with my mentor, I have my own copy, and I know what stays private and what doesn't

☐ My Reentry Plan has a next step in all eight areas

My mentor _____ **Mentor's phone** _____ **We meet** _____

My anchor _____ **My first class** _____ **The class meets** _____

MY COMMITMENT

I'm a stakeholder in this house, not a passenger. I commit to: lead by example in every circumstance; respect every person as I wish to be respected; keep this house safe, free from weapons, violence and fear; practice Service Over Self by helping the next resident grow; and live by the principles of Opportunity, Growth and Empowerment. **I will turn time served into time that serves others.**

_____ Resident

_____ Mentor, as witness

_____ Date

Thinking Under Pressure

FORGE FOR SUCCESS · CLASS 1 · EVERY AREA OF THE PLAN

THE BIG IDEA

Between every situation and every reaction there is a thought. The thought, not the situation, drives what you feel and what you do. Out here, the thoughts that do the most damage feel like facts: “Nobody’s going to hire me.” “My officer wants me back inside.” Ask: **Is this a fact or a thought? What’s the evidence for it, and against it?**

SITUATION → THOUGHT → FEELING → ACTION → CONSEQUENCE

STOP, WHEN THE FEELING IS ALREADY COMING UP

Stop. One breath. **T**hink: what’s the thought, and is it a fact? **O**ptions: two or three things I could do. **P**lan: pick the one that protects my plan.

A thought that feels like a fact for me right now:

The evidence for it, and against it:

My one action this week, and the thought I’ll use when the pressure hits:

This week: catch one thought. Write a thinking report on it, or tell your mentor about it.

The Officer and Other Authority

FORGE FOR SUCCESS · CLASS 2 · SUPERVISION AND LEGAL

THE BIG IDEA

Respect the role, even when you disagree with the person. Your officer has real authority over your supervision. You don't have to like them or agree with every call they make. The power you hold is composure and a clean record: **know your conditions exactly, be early, write everything down, and call before, not after.** The same habits work with a case manager, a court clerk, a landlord or house staff.

COMPOSURE AT THE COUNTER

The escalation curve: **1** calm, **2** agitated, **3** flooded, **4** crisis, **5** recovery. Step in at Stage 2, with **STOP**. **S**top: one breath. **T**hink: what's the thought, and is it a fact? **O**ptions: two or three things I could do. **P**lan: the one that protects my plan. When something seems unfair: **stay composed, write it down, ask legal services, never argue at the counter.**

My supervision record (start it here; keep it going in your folder)

Date	Who I saw, or what I paid	What I was told to do next	Copy or receipt?

My conditions, written exactly. I circle anything I'm not sure of:

If I'm going to be late or miss an appointment, I call (name and number) before, and I say:

Legal questions: POD Society legal services, _____

This week: be early to every appointment, and write every one down. Take anything you circled to your officer or to legal services.

Getting Hired: Your Story in Two Minutes

FORGE FOR SUCCESS · CLASS 3 · WORK

THE BIG IDEA

Your record is part of your story. It isn't the whole story. When an employer asks, tell it in two minutes: **what happened** (owned: no "just," no "but," no case details), **what changed** (with evidence), and **what you offer now**. Then stop and let them ask. **Full accountability is not full disclosure.** You owe them the truth, told briefly and owned, not every detail.

THE ACCOUNTABILITY SPECTRUM

Denial: "I didn't do it." **Minimization:** "It was just a little thing." **Blame-shifting:** "I was with the wrong people." **Partial ownership:** "I made a mistake, but..." **Full accountability:** "I made a choice that hurt people. There's no excuse for it. I served my time, and I spent it changing."

What happened, in one or two sentences, owned:

What changed, and my evidence:

What I offer now, and why this job:

Job center: _____

Questions about my record: POD Society legal services, _____

This week: say your two minutes out loud to three people, until you can say it without the page. Ask the job center about employers who hire people with records, and about the Work Opportunity Tax Credit and the Federal Bonding Program.

Keeping the Job

FORGE FOR SUCCESS · CLASS 4 · WORK

THE BIG IDEA

You keep a job one shift at a time. Be there, on time. When you can't, call your supervisor yourself, before the shift: who you are, what happened in one sentence, when you'll be there. Take a correction as information, not a verdict. Work out a conflict with the five steps. And **never quit at Stage 3**: STOP, finish the shift, call your mentor, sleep on it.

TAKING CORRECTION: SIX STEPS

Listen fully. Don't interrupt. **Breathe:** three seconds. **Reflect it back:** "So what you're saying is…" **Look for the truth,** even a grain of it. **Say thank you. Don't retaliate later.**

CONFLICT WITH A COWORKER: THE FIVE STEPS

1. Pause & Posture: don't react; breathe; shoulders down, hands visible. **2. Name the Heat:** "I can tell we're both frustrated." Never "calm down." **3. Facts > Stories:** what was said and done, not the story about it; give your side as SBI (Situation, Behavior, Impact). **4. Needs & Options:** what do we each need? Two or three ways to get there. **5. Agreement & Check-Back:** who does what, by when; then check back.

My call-in: who I call, how early, and what I say:

A correction I got (or expect) at work, and the grain of truth in it:

Before I ever quit in the moment, I will:

This week: show up early to every shift. Find out your job's call-in rule. The next time you're corrected, use the six steps.

Money on the Outside

FORGE FOR SUCCESS · CLASS 5 · MONEY

THE BIG IDEA

Budget from your take-home pay, never your gross. Decide where every dollar goes before payday, with savings first. Find out exactly what you owe and to whom, and put it in the plan. Before you sign any money deal, ask: **What will I pay in total, in dollars?** Don't sign the same day; show your mentor first.

GROSS PAY − DEDUCTIONS = NET (TAKE-HOME) PAY

This month	Planned	Actual
Take-home pay (all the paychecks this month)		
Savings, first		
Housing or program fee		
Phone		
Transportation (bus pass, gas, rides)		
Food		
Fees, fines, restitution		
Child support		
Work clothes, hygiene, other needs		
Everything else		
Total out (add up every line above except take-home)		
Left over (take-home minus total out)		

What I owe	To whom	How much	How I'll find out exactly

This week: before your next payday, fill in the Planned column for this month. After payday, fill in what really happened.

Coming Home to Family

FORGE FOR SUCCESS · CLASS 6 · FAMILY

THE BIG IDEA

Your family changed while you were away. Coming home is not picking up where you left off; it's starting over. Trust isn't a starting point. It's earned, one honest moment at a time. Own your part fully, with no "but," and let forgiveness be theirs to give, on their time.

Safety first: if there's a no-contact order or a supervision condition about contact, it comes first. Not sure? Ask your officer before you reach out. If someone is hurting you, or you're afraid you'll hurt someone, talk to your mentor.

The four steps	My plan for one conversation (only someone I'm allowed to contact)
1. What happened? The facts, and my part in them	
2. Who was affected, and how? The question I'll ask, and then I listen	
3. What needs to happen to make it right? What I can really offer	
4. How do we move forward? One promise I can keep, and when I'll check back	

One way my family changed while I was away, and one expectation I'm adjusting:

One small promise I'll keep this week, and to whom:

This week: keep one small promise to someone in your family. Show your conversation plan to your mentor before you have the conversation.

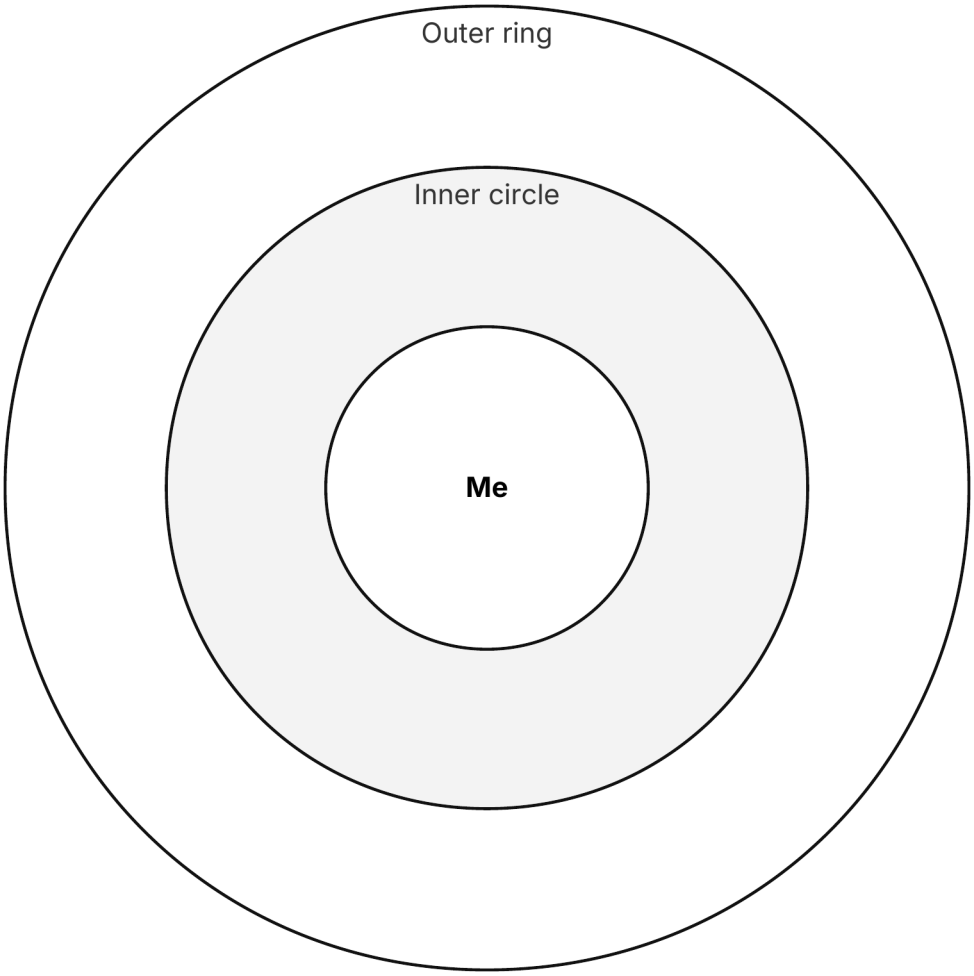
Old Friends, Old Places

FORGE FOR SUCCESS · CLASS 7 · HOUSING AND SERVICE

THE BIG IDEA

People, places and things from before still pull. You can't always remove people, but you choose how much access and influence each one gets. Supervision conditions about who you can be around come first; if you're not sure, ask your officer. Decide before the pressure hits, and when it's hot, ask the **10-10-10** questions: How will I feel about this in 10 minutes? In 10 months? In 10 years?

My map: people where they really are. **+** supports my growth · **–** pulls me back · **?** could go either way



A boundary I'll hold with a – or ? on my map:

My personal rules ("I will always…" / "I will never…"):

This week: read your rules every morning; tell your mentor when you used one. My new circle: _____

On Guard

FORGE FOR SUCCESS · CLASS 8 · HEALTH AND RECOVERY

THE BIG IDEA

Inside, being on guard kept you safe. That doesn't switch off at the gate. Crowds, noise, too many choices and people behind you can set off a survival response that belongs to the past. POD Society calls these lasting effects Post-Incarceration Syndrome (PICS). **It is not weakness.** Catch it at Stage 2 and use a tool.

1 CALM → 2 TRIGGERED → 3 FLOODED → 4 CRISIS → 5 COOL-DOWN (step in at 2)

THREE TOOLS

4-4-4 breathing, when your body is climbing: in for 4, hold for 4, out for 4, three times. **5-4-3-2-1 grounding,** when your mind is racing: 5 things you see, 4 you can touch, 3 you hear, 2 you smell, 1 you taste. **STOP,** when you have to decide: Stop, Think, Options, Plan.

Where I feel it first, and the response I go to most (fight, flight, freeze or fawn):

A hard place for me out here, and the tool I'll use there:

WHEN TO GET HELP

Talk to someone if it isn't easing after a few weeks, if it gets in the way of sleep, work or family, if nightmares, flashbacks or panic won't quit, or if you're using alcohol or drugs to get through it. **Thinking about hurting yourself or someone else? Get help now:** tell staff, use the crisis contact or call or text 988, and call 911 if anyone is in danger right now.

My person _____ **Mind C.A.R.E.** _____ **Mental health** _____ **Crisis** _____

This week: use one tool three times. Notice where you were on the curve before and after, and tell your mentor.

Recovery and the Stages of Change

FORGE FOR SUCCESS · CLASS 9 · HEALTH AND RECOVERY

THE BIG IDEA

Change happens in stages, and people move forward and back. A slip is information, not the end: one setback does not erase the growth before it. What decides what comes next is whether you hide it or tell someone the same day. Nobody carries this alone.

Stage	It sounds like	What helps
1. Precontemplation	"I don't have a problem."	Someone who stays around. Not a lecture.
2. Contemplation	"Maybe I have a problem, but..."	Weighing it: what would be different if I stopped?
3. Preparation	"I'm going to do something about this."	A concrete plan. Fragile: it can slip back.
4. Action	"I'm doing it."	Credit for the effort, help with what's hard.
5. Maintenance	"I'm keeping it going."	Remember how far you've come. Relapse is possible, especially under stress.

SAFETY

While you were inside, your tolerance dropped. Using the amount you used before can cause an overdose. **Naloxone (Narcan) reverses an opioid overdose.** Where to get it: _____ In an emergency, call 911.

My support network (closest to me first, then the gap)	Name	Number
My go-to person: the one I call when I'm struggling		
Someone who supports me		
Someone who supports me		
Someone who comes to me		
The gap: who or what I'm missing		

Meeting I'll try _____ **Recovery contact** _____ **Crisis line** _____

Two triggers I expect in the next month, and my plan for each:

If I slip, the first person I tell, the same day:

This week: know your triggers, and call one person on your map on a good day, so the number works on a bad one.

When It Goes Wrong

FORGE FOR SUCCESS · CLASS 10 · EVERY AREA OF THE PLAN

THE BIG IDEA

Setbacks happen: a lost job, a missed check-in, a fight at home, a slip in recovery, a violation. What decides the next six months is what you do in the next few hours. Own it with no "but." **Guilt says "I did something bad." Shame says "I am bad."** Guilt can be owned and fixed; shame makes people hide. One setback does not erase growth.

DENIAL → MINIMIZATION → BLAME-SHIFTING → PARTIAL OWNERSHIP → FULL ACCOUNTABILITY

AFTER A SETBACK, IN THE FIRST HOURS

Own it: "I [what I did]. It caused [what it caused]. I take full responsibility. I'm committed to [what I'll do]." **Tell it early:** my mentor, the same day, and my officer as my conditions require. Not sure if it has to be reported? Ask the same day. Never hide anything from your officer. **Take the next right step:** one step, not the whole fix. **Ask for help:** my mentor, my go-to person, this group.

My mentor _____ **My officer** _____

POD Society legal services _____ **My go-to person** _____

A setback I'm facing, or could face, said with no "but":

_____

_____

_____

The next right step, and who I tell first:

_____

_____

Someone in the house who is having a hard time, and how I'll show up for them:

_____

_____

WHEN IT'S SOMEONE ELSE'S SETBACK

Start with presence, not disappointment: "I heard what happened. I'm here. What's going on?" Ask questions first, then help them find one next step. No judgment, no "I would have done it better." Safety, a new crime or the house agreement goes to staff.

This week: if something goes wrong, tell someone the same day. Own it with no "but," and take one next step.

Giving Back

FORGE FOR SUCCESS · CLASS 11 · SERVICE

THE BIG IDEA

Turn time served into time that serves others. Service is a daily decision to make things better for the people around you, even when it costs you something. It is not submission, not performing for credit, and not control. When someone is counting on you, you have a reason to be the person you said you'd be, and someone newer is watching to see if it's possible. Your past is not a disqualification. It's a credential.

OARS	What it is	It sounds like
Open questions	Questions that can't be answered in one word	"What's going on with you today?" not "Are you okay?"
Affirmations	Specific, genuine, about effort. Not flattery.	"You've made every shift for three weeks. That takes discipline."
Reflections	Say back what you heard, as a statement	"You got out to be free, and this doesn't feel free yet."
Summaries	Pull it together, then check	"...Did I get that right?"

Three acts of service before next class. For someone else's benefit, no credit asked, and write down how it went.

Act of service	For whom	How it went

Someone in the house I could be an anchor or a listener for:

What "time that serves others" means for me:

My one action this week (Service), with a who and a when:

This week: do your three acts of service, and have one real conversation using OARS: an open question, one real affirmation, and reflect what you hear.

Your Next Address

FORGE FOR SUCCESS · CLASS 12 · HOUSING AND MONEY

THE BIG IDEA

The plan for your next address starts now, not the week you leave. A plan with no backup is a hope. Family housing is not always safe or stable: ask the same questions about any offer. **Where will I sleep the first night after I leave this house? Where will I be in a month? If that falls through, what's my backup?**

My move-out plan	What I have so far
Plan A: where I'll live	
Plan B: my backup	
Target month to move	
Savings target (deposit, first month, utilities, basics, the move, a cushion)	
Saved now, and how much each week (pay yourself first)	
What landlords will ask me for (pay stubs, ID, references)	
Two routines I'll keep	
My mentor and my go-to person, and how we'll stay in touch	
How I'll stay connected to the house	

WHEN YOUR RECORD COMES UP

Honestly, briefly, and looking forward: what happened, in a sentence; what you've done since; what you can show them now. Then ask: "What would you need to see to feel comfortable?" Questions about your rights as a renter go to POD Society legal services: _____

My one action this week (Housing or Money):

This week: answer the three questions, and tell your mentor your Plan A, your Plan B and your savings target. Pay yourself first, even a little.